



Based in San Francisco



EDUCATION

BSC ELECTRICAL & COMPUTER ENGINEERING

2016 – 2019 · University of Cape Town

- Graduated with First Class Honours as top BSc(Eng) student.
- Awarded the prize for the best final-year thesis.

SKILLS

LANGUAGES & TOOLS

Go, Python, SQL, Git, Docker, gRPC

DOMAINS

Distributed systems · P2P networks · protocol design · database migrations · code review at scale

Elle Mouton

Backend Software Engineer

ABOUT

Backend engineer with 5+ years building production-scale distributed systems. My work spans event-driven microservices serving millions of users and protocol-level upgrades to large, live peer-to-peer networks. I thrive in small, fast-moving teams with high ownership and high engineering standards.

Especially interested in developer tools, AI, and event-driven systems.

EXPERIENCE

Lightning Infrastructure Engineer | Lightning Labs

2021 – Present

One of the top contributors to [LND](#), the most widely-deployed Lightning Network implementation. My work centres on shipping protocol upgrades and large database migrations safely across a live peer-to-peer network of thousands of nodes. I also lead major features in the Lightning Terminal and Lightning Node Connect developer-tooling projects.

- Contributions to the Lightning Network protocol specification.
- Significant optimisations to the Neutrino (Bitcoin light-client) sync process.
- Extensive code review on a large, widely-used open-source codebase.

Software Engineer | Luno

2020 – 2021

Backend engineer on the crypto-operations team. Worked in Go on event-driven microservices handling high cryptocurrency volumes for millions of users.

PUBLIC APPEARANCES

- **Bitcoin++ Brazil (2025)** Technical hackathon judge.
- **Bitcoin Optech Podcast (Oct 2024)** Proposed updates to the Lightning gossip protocol.
- **Bitcoin Optech Podcast (Jul 2024)** Adding a BOLT11 invoice field for blinded paths.
- **The Chaincode Podcast (2023)** Simple Taproot Channels on the Lightning Network.
- **Advancing Bitcoin Conference, London (2022)** Static invoices on the Lightning Network.
- **Connect The World Podcast (2022)** All things Lightning.

WRITING

Deep-dive technical posts on Bitcoin and Lightning Network internals, widely read across the community. ellemouton.com/articles →